SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

23 September 2024 · Shift 2

82 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 18 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 6408 × 8 + 27 – 15 ÷ 10 = ?

(A) 922
(B) 923
(C) 924
(D) 921

Q.2

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 81, 65, 50, ?, 23, 11

(A) 37
(B) 34
(C) 35
(D) 36

Q.3

In a certain code language, X + Y means 'X is the sister of Y', X – Y means 'X is the son of Y', X × Y means 'X is the husband of Y', X ÷ Y means 'X is the mother of Y'. Based on the above, how is T related to X if 'T + U – V × W ÷ X'?

(A) Sister
(B) Father's sister
(C) Mother's sister
(D) Father's mother

Q.4

Three statements are given followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All crows are parrots. All eagles are parrots. All parrots are birds. Conclusions: I. No crow is a bird. II. Some birds are eagles. III. All birds are crows.

(A) All conclusions follow.
(B) Both conclusions I and III follow.
(C) Either conclusion II or III follows.
(D) Only conclusion II follows.

Q.5

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different. The odd one out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter cluster

(A) RTTUWW
(B) NOPPSS
(C) ACCDFF
(D) IKKLNN

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'FLAKE' is written as '&2348' and 'LAKES' is written as '23@84'. How will 'S' be written in that language?

(A) 4
(B) 3
(C) &
(D) @

Q.9

The position of how many letters will remain unchanged if each of the letter in the word 'IMPROVE' is arranged in English alphabetical order?

(A) One
(B) Three
(C) Two
(D) Zero

Q.12

Three Statements are given followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All peas are vegetables. All carrots are vegetables. All vegetables are greens. Conclusions: I. All peas are greens. II. All greens are carrots. III. Some greens are peas.

(A) Both conclusions II and III follow.
(B) All conclusions follow.
(C) Both conclusions I and III follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.13

The same operation(s) are followed in all the given number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 12 : 8
(B) 24 : 4
(C) 72 : 48
(D) 36 : 24

Q.14

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? $15 - 7 \div 4 + 36 \times 9 = ?$

(A) 42
(B) 39
(C) 34
(D) 40

Q.15

In a certain code language, 'BAKE' is coded as 'FDMF' and 'TURN' is coded as 'XXTO'. How will 'MOCK' be coded in the given language?

(A) RQGL
(B) QREL
(C) QSEL
(D) RRFL

Q.16

Select the term from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. MY 84, KW 80, IU 76, GS 72, ?

(A) FP 69
(B) EQ 68
(C) ER 70
(D) FQ 71

Q.18

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the given sets. (3, 9, 27) (4, 16, 64) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (6, 36, 84)
(B) (9, 81, 731)
(C) (7, 49, 343)
(D) (5, 25, 120)

Q.19

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? XJUM, VLSO, TNQQ, RPOS, ?

(A) PRMT
(B) QRMT
(C) PRNU
(D) PRMU

Q.20

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of numbers. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 4 : 32 7 : 98

(A) 12 : 144
(B) 10 : 1000
(C) 8 : 192
(D) 3 : 18

Q.21

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (84, 63, 42) (79, 47, 64) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (71, 53, 36)
(B) (64, 51, 52)
(C) (67, 48, 57)
(D) (75, 33, 48)

Q.22

Select the word-pair that best represents a similar relationship to the one expressed in the pair of words given below. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Frequency : Hertz

(A) Power : Newton
(B) Resistance : Candela
(C) Illuminance : Lux
(D) Force : Volt

Q.25

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. X _ _ Y_X X _ _ X _ _

(A) Y X X Y Y X X
(B) X X Y Y A A X
(C) X X X Y X X Y
(D) Y Y X Y A X X

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Who among the following Indian classical dancers is associated with Kuchipudi?

(A) Meenakshi Medhi
(B) Sanjukta Panigrahi
(C) Malavika Sarkar
(D) Vempati Chinna Satyam

Q.2

How many ICC World Cups has India won in ODI?

(A) 3
(B) 2
(C) 4
(D) 1

Q.3

With reference of Ajivikas, consider the following statements. a) Makkhali Gosala was the prominent teacher of this sect. b) Ajivikas believed in fatalism. Which of the above statements is/are correct?

(A) Both a and b
(B) Neither a or b
(C) Only b
(D) Only a

Q.4

Who first stated the principle of refraction that postulates that every substance has a specific bending ratio – 'refractive index'?

(A) Dennis Gabor
(B) Thomas Young
(C) David Brewster
(D) Willebrord Snellius

Q.5

Who among the following was appointed as the Chief Economic Advisor (CEA) to the Indian government in 2022?

(A) Raghuram Rajan
(B) Kaushik Basu
(C) TV Somanathan
(D) Venkatramanan Anantha Nageswaran

Q.6

Which Article in the fundamental duty is invoked when you see in a private party that the Indian flag has been used as a covering for the speaker's desk?

(A) Article 51A (b)
(B) Article 51A (c)
(C) Article 51A (d)
(D) Article 51A (a)

Q.7

Kati Bihu is celebrated in which of the following months in Assam?

(A) March
(B) November
(C) January
(D) October

Q.8

Coir conductor Coomi Nariman Wadia was awarded with which of the following awards by the Government of India in 2023?

(A) Padma Vibhushan
(B) Bharat Ratna
(C) Padma Bhushan
(D) Padma Shri

Q.9

What is the gas evolved when zinc reacts with sulphuric acid?

(A) Carbon dioxide
(B) Oxygen
(C) Hydrogen sulphide
(D) Hydrogen

Q.10
Name the pension scheme that seeks to ensure old age protection for unorganised workers.

(A) Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojna
(B) Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maandhan
(C) Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bhima Yojna
(D) Atal Pension Yojana

Q.11
Who published Systema Naturae in 1735 classifying the three kingdoms of nature and outlining the sexual system for the classification of plants?

(A) Carolus Linnaeus
(B) Robert Whittaker
(C) Ernst Haeckel
(D) Carl Woese

Q.12
In 2022, who has been appointed as new Attorney General of India?

(A) R Venkatramani
(B) Mukul Rohatgi
(C) Niren De
(D) KK Venugopal

Q.13
The most common rainfall measurement is the total rainfall depth during a given period, which is expressed in _____.

(A) millimetres (mm)
(B) hectopascal (hPa)
(C) millibar (mbar)
(D) kilopascal (kPa)

Q.14
Which of the following is NOT a kharif crop?

(A) Cotton
(B) Paddy
(C) Wheat
(D) Soyabean

Q.15
Which of the following statements about the second five-year plan is INCORRECT?

(A) The plan was based on the Keynesian Model.
(B) Electricity, Railway, Steel etc. industries were established during the plan.
(C) The plan stressed the rapid industrialisation of heavy and basic industries.
(D) The socialist pattern of the society was reflected in the plan.

Q.16
Being the President of the Indian National Congress, who among the following had called for complete independence from the British Raj in 1929?

(A) Subhas Chandra Bose
(B) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Mahatma Gandhi

Q.17
Which of the following is NOT a tributary of Ganga?

(A) Yamuna
(B) Kosi
(C) Lohit
(D) Gandak

Q.18
Which of the following ministries launched the PM Daksh scheme?

(A) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
(B) Ministry of Education
(C) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
(D) Ministry of Food Processing Industries

Q.19

When a person is NOT paying anything for public goods, it is known as _____.

(A) private good
(B) rivalrous
(C) non-excludable
(D) free rider

Q.20

Which of the following team events is included in the Target Olympic Podium Scheme?

(A) Hockey
(B) Cricket
(C) Football
(D) Tennis

Q.21

_____ is often touted as Tansen of the 20th century, this musical genius blended the best of classical music and created a unique style of his own.

(A) Ustad Ali Baksh Khan
(B) Bade Ghulam Ali Khan
(C) Barkat Ali Khan
(D) Mubarak Ali Khan

Q.22

In 1936, The Independent Labour Party was founded by _____.

(A) BR Ambedkar
(B) Bhagat Singh
(C) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(D) Mohan Singh Bhakhna

Q.23

Which of the following is another name of vitamin C?

(A) Pyridoxal
(B) Pyridoxine
(C) Pyridoxamine
(D) Ascorbic acid

Q.24

Articles 214 to 231 in Part VI of the Indian Constitution deal with the _____.

(A) High Courts
(B) Supreme Court
(C) Subordinate Courts
(D) District Courts

Q.25

Which of the following Sultans of Delhi primarily adopted a policy of consolidation rather than expansion?

(A) Bahlol Lodi
(B) Ibrahim Lodi
(C) Balban
(D) Alauddin Khalji

Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

Q.2

XAB and XCD are two secants to a circle. If XA = 18 cm, AB = 22 cm and XC = 24 cm, then find the value of XD (in cm).

(A) 28
(B) 34
(C) 30
(D) 21

Q.4

Find the fourth proportional to 4, 9 and 16.

(A) 36
(B) 18
(C) 16
(D) 27

Q.6

If the medians of a triangle are equal, then the triangle will be:

(A) right angled triangle
(B) obtuse angle triangle
(C) scalene triangle
(D) equilateral triangle

Q.8

The length, breadth and height of a room is 15 m, 9 m, and 5 m, respectively. From each can of paint 40 square metre of area is painted. How many cans of paint will be needed to paint only the walls of the room?

(A) 6
(B) 12
(C) 8
(D) 4

Q.9

A motorboat, whose speed in 15 km/h in still water goes 50 km downstream and comes back in a total of 7 hours 30 minutes. The speed of the stream (in km/h) is:

(A) 5
(B) 11
(C) 9
(D) 7

Q.11

The marked price of a bed sheet is ₹500. At the time of its sale, two successive discounts of 10% and 5% are available. Find the selling price (in ₹) of the bed sheet.

(A) 427.50
(B) 430.00
(C) 445.00
(D) 432.50

Q.12

Hema is 20 years old and her sister Neha is 30 years old. How many years ago were their ages in the ratio of 3 : 5?

(A) 5
(B) 3
(C) 2
(D) 7

Q.15

Three pipes, P, Q and R, together take four hours to fill a tank. All the three pipes were opened at the same time. After three hours, P was closed, and Q and R filled the remaining tank in two hours. How many hours will P alone take to fill the tank?

(A) 10
(B) 12
(C) 8
(D) 9

Q.17

The distance between the longest chord and the centre of a circle is:

(A) equal to the diameter
(B) equal to the radius
(C) equal to the half of the radius
(D) equal to zero unit

Q.19

A mango juice is made by mixing water and mango concentrate in the ratio 9 : 7. If x litres of water and 3x litres of mango concentrate is mixed in 160 litres of mango juice, then the new ratio becomes 13 : 14. What is the quantity of the new mango juice (in litres)?

(A) 206
(B) 216
(C) 197
(D) 212

Q.22

The marked price of 55 items was equal to the cost price of 99 items. The selling price of 56 items was equal to the marked price of 35 items. Calculate the profit or loss percentage from the sale of each item.

(A) 12.5% profit
(B) 15% profit
(C) 12.25% profit
(D) 12.5% loss

Q.23

The least number which must be subtracted from 7278745 so as to obtain a sum that is divisible by 11 is:

(A) 1
(B) 3
(C) 5
(D) 2

Q.24

Ten chairs and six tables together cost ₹5,140; three chairs and two tables together cost ₹1,635. The cost of 1 chair and 1 table is:

(A) ₹800
(B) ₹700
(C) ₹900
(D) ₹600

Q.25

In an election between two candidates, P received 42% of the valid votes and Q won by 45,360 votes. 20% people did not cast their vote. If 10% of the votes cast were found invalid, what is the total number of votes registered in the poll booth?

(A) 3,59,000
(B) 3,53,790
(C) 3,93,750
(D) 3,93,600

English Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Obstinate

(A) Submissive
(B) Stubborn
(C) Adaptive
(D) Obedient

Q.2

Select the correctly spelt word to fill in the blank. My grandmother _____ the preparation of every festival celebration in my house.

(A) inetiates
(B) initiates
(C) enitiates
(D) enetiates

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Aesthetic value is specifically a way in which we “can get positive conclude value” from the world at large.

(A) can get positive convalescent value
(B) can get positive contrastive value
(C) can get positive conclusive value
(D) can get positive convulsive value

Q.4

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. P. and has also created a wide gap between them Q. laid too much stress on R. teachers and students S. online mode of education has

(A) SQRP
(B) PSQR
(C) RQPS
(D) SRPQ

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A thing that can be easily carried by hands

(A) Import
(B) Portable
(C) Potable
(D) Export

Q.6

In the question, four alternatives are given for the underlined word in the sentence. Choose the alternative which best expresses the opposite meaning of the word. It was as if the newer hybrids had an “insatiable” appetite for chemicals.

(A) Curbed
(B) Urgent
(C) Pressing
(D) Satisfiable

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Left out in the cold

(A) To be in hiding
(B) To be ignored
(C) To go underground
(D) To be extremely negative

Q.8

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. He always wants to be in the company of those who are intellectually superior than him.

(A) those who are intellectually
(B) superior than him.
(C) He always wants to
(D) be in the company of

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Break the ice

(A) Nervousness before a performance
(B) To say or do something that makes people feel more relaxed, especially at the beginning of a meeting, party
(C) Respect for someone’s achievements
(D) Ill-feeling carried by a person over a period of time

Q.10

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. I have sing ‘Let It Go’ before a crowd of thousands of people.

(A) thousands of people
(B) a crowd of
(C) I have sing
(D) ‘Let It Go’ before

Q.11

Identify the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Lady Stranleigh continued to smile at him “brilliantly.”

(A) Brightly
(B) Dimly
(C) Cunningly
(D) Strangely

Q.12

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. O. want P. movie tonight Q. do you R. to watch S. the

(A) OSPQR
(B) RSPQO
(C) OSQPR
(D) QORSP

Q.13

Select the option that correctly expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Mr. Amar refused him admittance.

(A) Admittance would be refused to him by Mr. Amar.
(B) Admittance shall be refused to him by Mr. Amar.
(C) Admittance was refused to him by Mr. Amar.
(D) Admittance will be refused to him by Mr. Amar.

Q.14

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. P) always favours Q) only the R) fortune S) bold

(A) RPQS
(B) SQPR
(C) SRQP
(D) PQRS

Q.15

Select the most appropriate homophone to fill in the blank. The summer was _____ hot this year.

(A) to
(B) tow
(C) two
(D) too

Q.16

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. A. Only for themselves B. Is full of C. People who live D. The world

(A) BCAD
(B) ABCD
(C) DBAC
(D) DBCA

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The mothers, who suffer from postpartum depression, feel _____ by their children. (vexed)

(A) delighted
(B) pacific
(C) annoyed
(D) recovered

Q.18

Select the correct spelling of the underlined word in the sentence. Can you please come back to reality from the “fectitious” world you live in?

(A) factional
(B) fractional
(C) fictitious
(D) factitious

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Purify

(A) Chant
(B) Invite
(C) Pollute
(D) Wash

Q.20

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. Trigonometry has been taught by him for donkey’s years.

(A) He has been teaching trigonometry for donkey’s years.
(B) He had been teaching trigonometry for donkey’s years.
(C) He is teaching trigonometry for donkey’s years.
(D) He has been trigonometry teaching for donkey’s years.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Music is perhaps the most popular and widely practised (1)_____ of fine arts, transcending all kinds of cultural and linguistic barriers. Any form of fine art is (2)_____ to master and almost impossible to perfect, and music is no exception. Nature, it is learnt, has blessed almost two-thirds of the human race with musical ability of some sort. Music has the power to (3)_____ out the deepest emotions. In fact, it is a magic medicine, and many seek refuge in it when they are depressed or stressed. It is this intimacy that makes us listen to music (4)_____ even hum or sing sometimes. This singing, or realistically speaking, expressing one's emotion musically sometimes takes a serious turn. The desire to sing before an audience is innocent and beautiful, and indeed, it is perfectly alright to have such a genuine desire. But it is also important to understand that singing is an (5)_____ art—a highly refined one at that, which requires systematic, prolonged and strict training to be acceptable.

Choose the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) form
(B) design
(C) format
(D) substance

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Music is perhaps the most popular and widely practised (1)_____ of fine arts, transcending all kinds of cultural and linguistic barriers. Any form of fine art is (2)_____ to master and almost impossible to perfect, and music is no exception. Nature, it is learnt, has blessed almost two-thirds of the human race with musical ability of some sort. Music has the power to (3)_____ out the deepest emotions. In fact, it is a magic medicine, and many seek refuge in it when they are depressed or stressed. It is this intimacy that makes us listen to music (4)_____ even hum or sing sometimes. This singing, or realistically speaking, expressing one's emotion musically sometimes takes a serious turn. The desire to sing before an audience is innocent and beautiful, and indeed, it is perfectly alright to have such a genuine desire. But it is also important to understand that singing is an (5)_____ art—a highly refined one at that, which requires systematic, prolonged and strict training to be acceptable.

Choose the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) difficult
(B) easy
(C) irksome
(D) serious

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Music is perhaps the most popular and widely practised (1)_____ of fine arts, transcending all kinds of cultural and linguistic barriers. Any form of fine art is (2)_____ to master and almost impossible to perfect, and music is no exception. Nature, it is learnt, has blessed almost two-thirds of the human race with musical ability of some sort. Music has the power to (3)_____ out the deepest emotions. In fact, it is a magic medicine, and many seek refuge in it when they are depressed or stressed. It is this intimacy that makes us listen to music (4)_____ even hum or sing sometimes. This singing, or realistically speaking, expressing one's emotion musically sometimes takes a serious turn. The desire to sing before an audience is innocent and beautiful, and indeed, it is perfectly alright to have such a genuine desire. But it is also important to understand that singing is an (5)_____ art—a highly refined one at that, which requires systematic, prolonged and strict training to be acceptable.

Choose the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) catalyse
(B) yield
(C) bring
(D) effect

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Music is perhaps the most popular and widely practised (1)_____ of fine arts, transcending all kinds of cultural and linguistic barriers. Any form of fine art is (2)_____ to master and almost impossible to perfect, and music is no exception. Nature, it is learnt, has blessed almost two-thirds of the human race with musical ability of some sort. Music has the power to (3)_____ out the deepest emotions. In fact, it is a magic medicine, and many seek refuge in it when they are depressed or stressed. It is this intimacy that makes us listen to music (4)_____ even hum or sing sometimes. This singing, or realistically speaking, expressing one's emotion musically sometimes takes a serious turn. The desire to sing before an audience is innocent and beautiful, and indeed, it is perfectly alright to have such a genuine desire. But it is also important to understand that singing is an (5)_____ art—a highly refined one at that, which requires systematic, prolonged and strict training to be acceptable.

Choose the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) neither
(B) nor
(C) or
(D) either

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Music is perhaps the most popular and widely practised (1)_____ of fine arts, transcending all kinds of cultural and linguistic barriers. Any form of fine art is (2)_____ to master and almost impossible to perfect, and music is no exception. Nature, it is learnt, has blessed almost two-thirds of the human race with musical ability of some sort. Music has the power to (3)_____ out the deepest emotions. In fact, it is a magic medicine, and many seek refuge in it when they are depressed or stressed. It is this intimacy that makes us listen to music (4)_____ even hum or sing sometimes. This singing, or realistically speaking, expressing one's emotion musically sometimes takes a serious turn. The desire to sing before an audience is innocent and beautiful, and indeed, it is perfectly alright to have such a genuine desire. But it is also important to understand that singing is an (5)_____ art—a highly refined one at that, which requires systematic, prolonged and strict training to be acceptable.

Choose the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) uncomplicated
(B) uniform
(C) mixed
(D) intricate

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**
Q.12 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**
Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**				

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) 924

After interchanging the signs: 6408 ÷ 8 – 27 + 15 × 10 = 801 – 27 + 150 = 924.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 36

The differences are –16, –15, –14, –13, –12: 81, 65, 50, 36, 23, 11. So 50 – 14 = 36.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Sister

T is U's sister and U is V's son, so T is V's daughter. V is W's husband and W is X's mother, so X is also V and W's child: T is X's sister.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Only conclusion II follows.

Every crow and every eagle is a parrot, and every parrot a bird. So all crows are birds (I fails), and as all eagles are birds, some birds are eagles (II follows). Nothing says all birds are crows (III).

Q.5 · Answer (B) NOPPSS

RTTUWW, ACCDFF and IKKLNN follow the steps +2, 0, +1, +2, 0 (R T T U W W). NOPPSS goes +1, +1, 0, +3, 0, so it is the odd one.

Q.8 · Answer (D) @

L, A, K and E are in both words, as are 2, 3, 4 and 8 in both codes. The letter left in LAKES is S and the symbol left in its code is @, so S = @ (and F = &).

Q.9 · Answer (D) Zero

IMPROVE in alphabetical order is E I M O P R V. Position by position (I/E, M/I, P/M, R/O, O/P, V/R, E/V) no letter stays where it was.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Both conclusions I and III follow.

All peas are vegetables and all vegetables are greens, so all peas are greens (I), and therefore some greens are peas (III). Nothing makes all greens carrots (II).

Q.13 · Answer (B) 24 : 4

In 12 : 8, 72 : 48 and 36 : 24 the second number is two-thirds of the first. Two-thirds of 24 is 16, not 4, so 24 : 4 is the odd one.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 39

After interchanging the signs: 15 + 7 × 4 – 36 ÷ 9 = 15 + 28 – 4 = 39.

Q.15 · Answer (B) QREL

The letters move +4, +3, +2, +1: BAKE → FDMF and TURN → XXTO. So MOCK → QREL.

Q.16 · Answer (B) EQ 68

Both letters move back 2 each time (M, K, I, G, E and Y, W, U, S, Q) and the number falls by 4: EQ 68.

Q.18 · Answer (C) (7, 49, 343)

Each set is a number, its square and its cube: 3, 9, 27 and 4, 16, 64. Likewise 7, 49 and 343.

Q.19 · Answer (D) PRMU

The first and third letters move back 2 (X, V, T, R, P and U, S, Q, O, M) and the second and fourth forward 2 (J, L, N, P, R and M, O, Q, S, U): PRMU.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 3 : 18

The second number is twice the square of the first: $2 \times 4^2 = 32$ and $2 \times 7^2 = 98$. Likewise $2 \times 3^2 = 18$.

Q.21 · Answer (A) (71, 53, 36)

The third number is twice the difference of the first two: 2 × (84 – 63) = 42 and 2 × (79 – 47) = 64. Likewise 2 × (71 – 53) = 36.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Illuminance : Lux
The hertz is the SI unit of frequency, as the lux is of illuminance. Power is measured in watts, resistance in ohms and force in newtons.

Q.25 · Answer (C) X X X Y X X Y
With X, X, X, Y, X, X, Y in the blanks the block XXXY repeats: XXXY XXXY XXXY.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Vempati Chinna Satyam
Vempati Chinna Satyam was one of the great gurus of Kuchipudi, the classical dance of Andhra Pradesh. Sanjukta Panigrahi was an Odissi dancer.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 2
India won the ODI World Cup in 1983 and 2011.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Both a and b
Makkhali Gosala was the leading teacher of the Ajivikas, who held that everything is fixed by fate (niyati). Both statements are correct.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Willebrord Snellius
Willebrord Snellius (Snell) found in 1621 that the sines of the angles of incidence and refraction are in a constant ratio for two given media: Snell's law, the basis of the refractive index.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Venkatramanan Anantha Nageswaran
V. Anantha Nageswaran was appointed Chief Economic Adviser in January 2022, succeeding K. V. Subramanian.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Article 51A (a)
Article 51A(a) asks every citizen to abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag and the National Anthem. The Flag Code forbids using the flag to cover a speaker's desk.

Q.7 · Answer (D) October
Kati (Kongali) Bihu falls in mid-October, in the Assamese month of Kati, when lamps are lit in the paddy fields.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Padma Shri
Coomi Nariman Wadia, the Mumbai choir conductor of the Paranjoti Academy Chorus, received the Padma Shri in 2023.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Hydrogen
Zinc displaces hydrogen from dilute sulphuric acid: $Zn + H_2SO_4 \rightarrow ZnSO_4 + H_2$.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maandhan
SSC's key gives the Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maandhan (2019), set up for the old-age protection and social security of unorganised workers; it pays ₹3,000 a month from the age of 60. (The Atal Pension Yojana is also aimed mainly at the unorganised sector, but is open to citizens in general.)

Q.11 · Answer (A) Carolus Linnaeus
Carl Linnaeus published 'Systema Naturae' in 1735, setting out his classification of nature and his sexual system for plants.

Q.12 · Answer (A) R Venkatramani
R. Venkataramani became Attorney General of India on 1 October 2022, succeeding K. K. Venugopal.

Q.13 · Answer (A) millimetres (mm)
Rainfall is measured as the depth of water collected, in millimetres; hectopascals, millibars and kilopascals are units of pressure.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Wheat
Wheat is a rabi crop, sown in winter and harvested in spring. Cotton, paddy and soyabean are kharif crops, sown with the monsoon.

Q.15 · Answer (A) The plan was based on the Keynesian Model.
The Second Plan (1956-61) was based on P. C. Mahalanobis's model, not the Keynesian one. It did stress heavy industry, with the steel plants at Bhilai, Durgapur and Rourkela, in pursuit of a socialist pattern of society.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Jawaharlal Nehru
Jawaharlal Nehru presided over the Lahore session of the Congress in December 1929, which adopted the Purna Swaraj resolution.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Lohit
The Lohit is a tributary of the Brahmaputra. The Yamuna, Kosi and Gandak all join the Ganga.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
PM-DAKSH, a skill-development scheme for Scheduled Castes, backward classes and sanitation workers, is run by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.

Q.19 · Answer (D) free rider
Public goods are non-excludable, so people can enjoy them without paying; such a person is a free rider.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Hockey
TOPS, the Sports Ministry's scheme for athletes with Olympic medal prospects, includes India's men's and women's hockey teams.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Bade Ghulam Ali Khan
Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, the Patiala gharana vocalist, is often called the Tansen of the 20th century.

Q.22 · Answer (A) BR Ambedkar
B. R. Ambedkar founded the Independent Labour Party in 1936.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Ascorbic acid
Vitamin C is ascorbic acid. Pyridoxal, pyridoxine and pyridoxamine are forms of vitamin B6.

Q.24 · Answer (A) High Courts
Chapter V of Part VI (Articles 214 to 231) deals with the High Courts in the States; the subordinate courts follow in Chapter VI (Articles 233 to 237).

Q.25 · Answer (C) Balban
Balban concentrated on consolidating the Sultanate, strengthening the army and the Crown's authority, rather than conquering new lands. Alauddin Khalji, by contrast, expanded far into the Deccan.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (C) 30
By the secant theorem XA × XB = XC × XD. XB = 18 + 22 = 40, so 18 × 40 = 24 × XD and XD = 30 cm.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 36
4 : 9 = 16 : x, so x = 9 × 16/4 = 36.

Q.6 · Answer (D) equilateral triangle
If all three medians are equal, all three sides are equal: the triangle is equilateral.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 6
The four walls cover 2(15 + 9) × 5 = 240 m², and 240/40 = 6 cans.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 5
$50/(15 + s) + 50/(15 - s) = 7.5$ gives $1500/(225 - s^2) = 7.5$, so $225 - s^2 = 200$ and s = 5 km/h.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 427.50
₹500 × 0.9 × 0.95 = ₹427.50.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 5
(20 – x)/(30 – x) = 3/5 gives 100 – 5x = 90 – 3x, so x = 5: 15 and 25 years.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 8
Together they fill 1/4 of the tank an hour, so 3/4 in three hours. Q and R fill the remaining 1/4 in 2 hours, so 1/8 an hour; P alone fills 1/4 – 1/8 = 1/8 an hour and takes 8 hours.

Q.17 · Answer (D) equal to zero unit
The longest chord is a diameter, which passes through the centre, so its distance from the centre is zero.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 216
The 160 litres hold 90 litres of water and 70 of concentrate. (90 + x)/(70 + 3x) = 13/14 gives 1260 + 14x = 910 + 39x, so x = 14. The new juice is 160 + 4 × 14 = 216 litres.

Q.22 · Answer (A) 12.5% profit
MP/CP = 99/55 = 9/5 and SP/MP = 35/56 = 5/8, so SP/CP = 9/8: a profit of 12.5%.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 1
The alternating sum of the digits from the right is 5 – 4 + 7 – 8 + 7 – 2 + 7 = 12, which leaves remainder 1 on division by 11. Subtracting 1 gives 7278744 = 11 × 661704.

Q.24 · Answer (B) ₹700
Three times the second equation is 9 chairs + 6 tables = ₹4,905; subtracting it from the first gives 1 chair = ₹235. Then 2 tables = ₹1,635 – ₹705 = ₹930, so a table is ₹465 and a chair and a table ₹700.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 3,93,750
Q got 58% and P 42% of the valid votes, so the margin of 45,360 is 16% of them: 2,83,500 valid votes. They are 90% of the votes cast (3,15,000), which are 80% of the votes registered: 3,93,750.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) Stubborn
'Obstinate' means refusing to change one's mind: 'stubborn'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) initiates
The correct spelling is 'initiates'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) can get positive conclusive value
An adjective is needed before 'value', not the verb 'conclude': 'conclusive' is the adjective formed from it.

Q.4 · Answer (A) SQRP
'Online mode of education has (S) laid too much stress on (Q) teachers and students (R) and has also created a wide gap between them (P).'

Q.5 · Answer (B) Portable
Something easily carried is 'portable'; 'potable' means fit to drink.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Satisfiable
'Insatiable' means impossible to satisfy; its opposite is 'satisfiable'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) To be ignored
To be 'left out in the cold' is to be ignored or excluded.

Q.8 · Answer (B) superior than him.
'Superior' takes 'to', not 'than': 'superior to him'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) To say or do something that makes people feel more relaxed, especially at the beginning of a meeting, party
To 'break the ice' is to ease the tension when people first meet.

Q.10 · Answer (C) I have sing
The present perfect needs the past participle: 'I have sung'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Dimly
To smile 'brilliantly' is to smile brightly; the opposite is 'dimly'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) QORSP
'Do you (Q) want (O) to watch (R) the (S) movie tonight (P)?'

Q.13 · Answer (C) Admittance was refused to him by Mr. Amar.
The simple past 'refused' becomes 'was refused' in the passive: 'Admittance was refused to him by Mr. Amar.'

Q.14 · Answer (A) RPQS
'Fortune (R) always favours (P) only the (Q) bold (S).'

Q.15 · Answer (D) too
'Too' means excessively: 'too hot'. 'To', 'two' and 'tow' sound the same but mean something else.

Q.16 · Answer (D) DBCA
'The world (D) is full of (B) people who live (C) only for themselves (A).'

Q.17 · Answer (C) annoyed
'Vexed' means irritated: 'annoyed'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) fictitious
The correct spelling is 'fictitious', meaning imaginary. 'Factitious' (artificial) is a different word.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Pollute
To 'purify' is to make clean; the opposite is to 'pollute'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) He has been teaching trigonometry for donkey's years.
No option gives the plain present perfect 'He has taught trigonometry'; 'He has been teaching' keeps the present perfect, in its continuous form, which suits an action lasting 'for donkey's years'. The others move to the past perfect or the present continuous, or scramble the word order.

Q.21 · Answer (A) form
Music is a 'form' of fine art, as the next sentence says: 'Any form of fine art'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) difficult
Fine art is 'difficult' to master and almost impossible to perfect.

Q.23 · Answer (C) bring
To 'bring out' the deepest emotions is to draw them out; the other verbs do not go with 'out' in this sense.

Q.24 · Answer (C) or
'Listen to music or even hum or sing': 'or' joins the alternatives.

Q.25 · Answer (D) intricate
Singing is an 'intricate' art, 'a highly refined one' that needs strict training.

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